ANGLES

When to use degrees vs radians

Two unit systems, each with the jobs it is built for.

USE **degrees** FOR

NAVIGATION	Surveying and geographic coordinates: latitude, longitude, bearings.
ENGINEERING	Drawings, mechanical specifications, and most everyday measurement contexts.
HAND WORK	Angles that are simple fractions of a circle: 90°, 45°, 30°.
AUDIENCES	Non-mathematical audiences: "30 degrees" is intuitive in a way "$\pi/6$" is not.

USE **radians** FOR

CALCULUS	Derivatives, integrals and Taylor series of trig functions all assume radians.
PHYSICS	Angular velocity, simple harmonic motion, wave equations.
CODE	JavaScript's `Math.sin`, Python's `math.sin` and C's `sin` all take radians. Pass degrees in and you get nonsense.
EXACT VALUES	Any work where π should appear symbolically.

A COMMON WORKFLOW

THINK
Think and design in degrees

→

COMPUTE
Convert to radians when feeding values into a function or formula

→

SHOW
Convert back when displaying results to humans